

Let's turn to the last assumption that the free will defense requires: the assumption that free will is a great good.

Free will is a
great good.

Even God could not
have given us free
will while ensuring
that we never used
that free will to
bring about evil.

We have free
will.

Many people think that it is; many think that life would not be worth living, or at least would be considerably worse, if we did not have free will.

Here's one way to call that assumption into question:

It is very important that we **feel** as though we have free will. Life would not be worth living if I did not feel as though my decisions were up to me. But it does not matter to the value of my life whether I really have free will; I would be just as well off if I were convinced that I had free will, but really didn't.

Suppose that this were true. Why would that matter?

Well, God could presumably have given us the **feeling** of free will while ensuring that we never brought about evil. So if the feeling or illusion of free will is really all that matters, it seems like it would have been better for God to create a world in which we have the feeling of free will but in which there is no evil. But then why wouldn't a perfectly good being have created **that** world?



replies to
Libet

A solid red circle with a subtle drop shadow, centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the text "the Libet experiments" is written in a white, sans-serif font, centered both horizontally and vertically.

the Libet
experiments



is free will
an important
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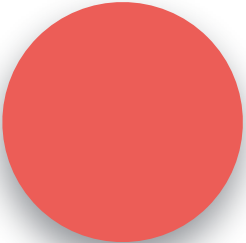


determinism. Our topic today is much more recent challenge to free

In ancient times, philosophers worried about the challenge to free will from fate. After

the birth of modern physics, many worried about the challenges it would bring from

will prosper by contemporary neuroscience.



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